

# SPIKE RUNNER

## OFFICIAL PLAYER GUIDE

*A fast reflex-based, gravity-shifting game*

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Jump, avoid, collect, shift, and survive.

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## About This Guide

Spike Runner, its artwork, and this player guide were produced with the assistance of artificial intelligence as an educational exercise in game design and documentation. Any resemblance between this game's concept, visuals, or naming and any existing commercial product is coincidental and unintentional. This material isn't for commercial distribution and is intended solely for learning purposes.

# 1. Introduction

Spike Runner is a reflex-based arcade game built around jumping, gravity changes, obstacle avoidance, and resource management. The player controls a blue square that automatically remains attached to either the bottom or top side of the arena. The game progressively becomes faster, requiring increasingly precise jumps and reactions.

## 2. Objective

Your main objective is to:

- Avoid red spikes
- Jump over obstacles
- Collect Green Strength Fuel
- Touch yellow Gravity Feed to invert gravity
- Maintain your strength
- Survive as long as possible
- Beat your previous score

The game doesn't have a traditional finish line. Your score continuously increases while you survive.

## 3. Getting Started

### 3.01 Starting the Spike Runner Game

Spike Runner runs entirely inside a single HTML file (Spike Runner.html) and requires no installation. The steps below work on any desktop operating system and any modern browser.

1. Locate the Spike Runner.html file on your computer (for example, in your Downloads folder).
2. Double-click the file. It normally opens automatically in your default web browser.
3. If it doesn't open automatically, right-click the file, choose **Open with**, and select a browser such as Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Mozilla Firefox, or Safari.
4. Alternatively, open your browser first, then select **File > Open File** (or press Ctrl+O on Windows or Linux, Cmd+O on Mac) and select Spike Runner.html.
5. Allow a few seconds for the page to finish loading, then follow the on-screen instructions to begin playing.

| Operating System | Quick Tip                                                                                           |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Windows          | Double-click the file in File Explorer, or right-click and select Open with to choose your browser. |
| macOS            | Double-click the file in Finder, or Control-click and select Open With to choose your browser.      |
| Linux            | Double-click the file in your file manager, or run xdg-open "Spike Runner.html" from a terminal.    |

This works identically for Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari, Brave, Opera, and most other modern browsers, since Spike Runner uses only standard web technologies.

## 3.02 After Starting the Game

When the game opens, you'll see the Spike Runner title screen. Read the instructions on screen, then continue using:

- Enter
- Space
- Mouse click
- Screen tap

You'll then reach the Theme Selection screen. Use arrow keys or a mouse click to select a theme, and press Enter to confirm.

The game then displays a short loading screen with a random gameplay tip. After loading finishes, gameplay begins.

## 4. Controls

Spike Runner is fully playable with the keyboard. The game responds to a small set of keys, so you can keep your eyes on the arena instead of the keyboard. Use the keys below during gameplay and at the title, theme, and Game Over screens.

### Desktop Keyboard

| Key         | Action                       |
|-------------|------------------------------|
| Space       | Jump                         |
| B           | Slow the game                |
| N           | Speed up the game            |
| P           | Pause or resume              |
| Enter       | Confirm or continue          |
| Left arrow  | Select Black theme           |
| Right arrow | Select White theme           |
| T           | Change theme after Game Over |

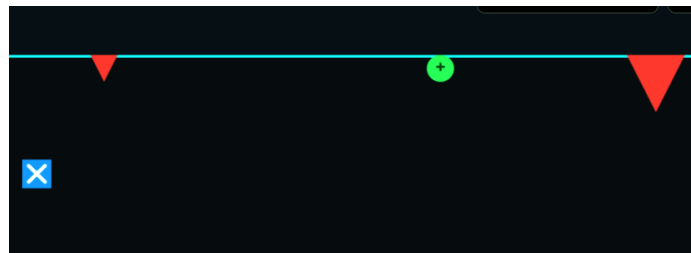
## 5. Gameplay

The arena has two possible gravity surfaces:

- Normally, the square travels along the current gravity surface.
- Red spikes appear ahead of the player—you must jump over them.
- Eventually, a special yellow Gravity Feed can change the direction of gravity.



*Bottom gravity, white theme: the player mid-jump over red spikes*



*Inverted gravity, black theme: the player at 0 strength, with green strength fuel ahead*

### 5.01 The Player

The player is represented by a plain blue square. The square has physical movement and rotation. During a jump it rotates smoothly, and the rotation depends on the current gravity direction.

#### ***Normal Bottom Gravity***

The square jumps upward and rotates clockwise. After landing, the square returns to a stable position.

#### ***Inverted Top Gravity***

When gravity is reversed, the square moves toward the top side. Its rotation direction is reversed so the movement stays visually consistent with the new gravity direction. When it lands on the top surface, it becomes stable again.

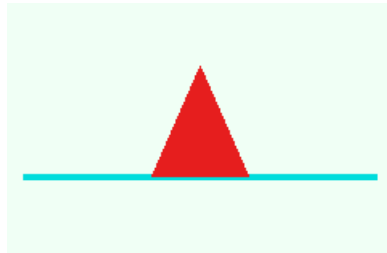


## 5.02 Red Spikes

Red spikes are the primary hazards. They appear randomly throughout gameplay. Spike heights vary—some spikes are short while others are considerably taller. However, spike heights always remain within the player's jump capability.

### *Spike Direction*

Actual in-game spikes, shown below for reference:

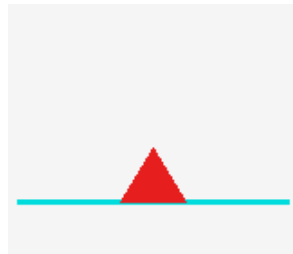


*Bottom gravity: spike points up*

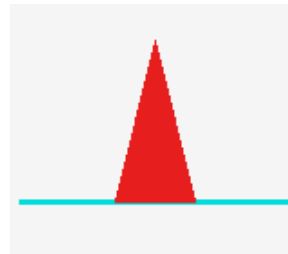


*Inverted gravity: spike points down*

Spike heights vary from short to tall, but they always remain within jumpable range:



*Short spike*



*Tall spike*

### *Spike Separation*

The game intentionally separates red spikes from one another. Spikes never spawn directly on top of, or merged with, another spike. This keeps individual obstacles readable and makes each jump meaningful.

## 5.03 Yellow Gravity Feed

The yellow square appears in the game is advantageous for player. If blue square touches yellow square, it gives a short relief from red spikes and changes the direction of gravity. With this gravity-shifting feature, the game is more adventurous and fun to play!



*Yellow Gravity Feed*

### ***When You Collect Yellow Gravity Feed:***

1. Gravity immediately reverses.
2. The player transitions toward the opposite side.
3. The game clears existing red spikes.
4. A temporary safe period begins.
5. The game holds off showing another Yellow Gravity Feed right away.
6. The square rotates during the transition.
7. Gameplay continues on the opposite side.

### ***Safe Period***

After gravity changes, the player receives a short period of safety. During this period, the game doesn't immediately place red spikes ahead of the player—this keeps the gravity transition fair.

## **5.04 Green Strength Fuel**

The green object is a medium-sized green circle with a black plus symbol.



*Green Strength Fuel*

### ***Collecting Green Fuel***

Touching the green circle grants strength +1. The screen briefly flashes light green, giving immediate visual feedback that you collected the pickup.

### ***Strength Limit***

The game limits the player's strength to 3. Collecting green fuel beyond the maximum doesn't let strength grow indefinitely.

## **5.05 Strength System**

Strength represents the player's ability to survive collisions. The game starts with Strength = 3.

### ***Red Spike Collision***

Every red spike collision removes 1 strength.



*Strength > 0*



*Hit red spike*



*Strength = 0*

If square's strength is 0, then one red spike collision will result in Game Over.

### ***Damaged State***

When strength reaches zero, the square displays a white X drawn directly on it, clearly showing that the player is damaged. A collision effect also briefly highlights the square.

### ***Next Fatal Collision***

If the player has zero strength and collides with another red spike, the game ends (Game Over).

## **5.06 Gravity System**

Gravity normally pulls the player toward the bottom surface. Yellow Gravity Feed reverses this.

| State  | Gravity  |
|--------|----------|
| Bottom | Downward |
| Top    | Upward   |



*Bottom gravity*



*Top gravity*

### ***Gravity Transition***

Gravity inversion is designed to feel physical rather than an instant teleport. The square moves toward the new surface while rotating. Once it reaches the surface, it becomes stable.

## 5.07 High Score

The score increases continuously while the player survives: more distance means a higher score. High Score is retained per browser session. The Gameplay screen displays High Score and Current Score during gameplay.

### *High Score*

When the player dies, the Game Over screen displays the result of the current run and whether you reached a new high score.

### *Restart*

Selecting Restart begins a completely new run. Gameplay starts again from Score = 0, Strength = 3, Gravity = Bottom. Restarting doesn't simply reload the HTML page.

## 5.08 Game Speed

The game progressively becomes faster. At the beginning, the game runs at normal speed. As the score increases, game speed increases, spikes arrive faster, and reaction time decreases—adding difficulty without traditional stages.

### *Manual Slowdown—Hold B*

Temporarily slows gameplay. Useful when:

- A tall spike approaches.
- Multiple objects are visible.
- Gravity has recently changed.
- You need more time to judge a jump.

### *Manual Speed Boost—Hold N*

Temporarily speeds up gameplay. Useful for experienced players who want a more challenging run.

## 5.09 Pause Mode

Press P to pause the game. The screen displays "Paused." Press P again to resume. While paused:

- Player physics stop.
- Spikes stop moving.
- Score stops increasing.
- Input can't accidentally trigger jumps.

## 5.10 Themes

Spike Runner provides two visual themes.

### ***Black Theme (Default)***

- Dark background
- White interface text
- Blue player
- Red spikes
- Yellow Gravity Feed
- Green Strength Fuel

The dark theme provides a classic arcade appearance.

### ***White theme***

The white theme changes the background to a light color while keeping the core gameplay colors—the player stays blue, spikes stay red, and fuel stays yellow and green.

| Input       | Result      |
|-------------|-------------|
| Left arrow  | Black theme |
| Right arrow | White theme |
| Enter       | Confirm     |

You can also select themes using the mouse or touchscreen.

## 5.11 Game Over

Game Over occurs when the player has no remaining strength and takes another damaging red-spike hit.

Available options include Restart and Change Theme.

### ***Restart***

Restarting starts a new game from zero. The player receives Strength = 3, Score = 0, Gravity = Bottom.

### ***Change Theme***

Selecting Change Theme returns you to the theme selector. You can choose Black or White without refreshing the webpage.

## 6. Strategy Tips

### 6.1 Watch Spike Height

Not every spike has the same height. Tall spikes require earlier and more deliberate jumping. Don't wait until the spike is directly beside the square.

### 6.2 Learn the Jump Arc

Spend the first few seconds learning how far the square travels during a normal jump. Once you understand the jump arc, obstacle timing becomes much easier.

### 6.3 Don't Panic During Gravity Changes

When a yellow square appears:

1. Prepare for the gravity change.
2. Touch the yellow Gravity Feed.
3. Follow the square's movement toward the new surface.
4. Use the safe transition period.
5. Prepare for inverted spikes.

### 6.4 Collect Green Fuel Carefully

Green fuel gives +1 strength and can be extremely valuable when your strength is low. However, don't take an unnecessary risk simply to collect it.

### 6.5 Use B Strategically

Holding B slows gameplay. Use it when the screen becomes difficult to read—for example, a tall spike combined with a gravity transition and green fuel can become much easier to manage while slowed down.

### 6.6 Use N for Challenge

Pressing N increases gameplay speed temporarily. Use it only when you're comfortable with the current obstacle pattern.

### 6.7 Use Pause

If you need to stop, press P to pause the game rather than leaving the browser tab.

## 7. Quick Reference

| Feature             | Action or Result               |
|---------------------|--------------------------------|
| Jump                | Space, tap, or click           |
| Slow                | Hold B                         |
| Speed up            | Hold N                         |
| Pause               | P                              |
| Restart             | Enter or Space after Game Over |
| Theme               | Left or right arrow            |
| Confirm theme       | Enter                          |
| Change theme        | T after Game Over              |
| Red spike           | -1 strength                    |
| Red spike collision | Spike destroyed                |
| Yellow square       | Reverse gravity                |
| Green circle        | +1 strength                    |
| Maximum Strength    | 3                              |
| Starting Strength   | 3                              |
| Zero Strength       | White X appears on square      |
| Fatal collision     | Game Over                      |
| Player              | Blue square                    |
| Red hazard          | Spike                          |
| Gravity Feed        | Yellow square                  |
| Strength Fuel       | Green circle                   |

## 8. Troubleshooting

**Q:** The game doesn't respond to keyboard input.

**A:** Click or tap the webpage once and try again. Make sure the browser tab is active.

**Q:** The game appears paused.

**A:** Press P to resume.

**Q:** The theme doesn't change.

**A:** On the theme selection screen, press the left arrow to select Black, the right arrow to select White, and Enter to confirm. You can also tap the theme you want.

**Q:** The game ends quickly.

**A:** Remember that strength decreases by 1 on each red-spike collision. Collect green strength fuel when it's safely reachable to stay alive longer.



## 9. Final Quick Start

If you only remember five things, remember these:

1. Space or tap: jump.
2. Avoid red spikes.
3. Yellow square: gravity changes.
4. Green circle: +1 strength.
5. P: Pause.





Survive longer, react faster,  
and score higher.

# **SPIKE RUNNER**

Jump, avoid, collect, shift, and survive.

